



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION
UNION PANAFRICAINNE DES ETUDIANTS
الاتحاد جميع الطلاب الأفريقي
Defending students rights since 1972



ENVIRONMENT & CLIMATE ACTION
WORKING GROUP

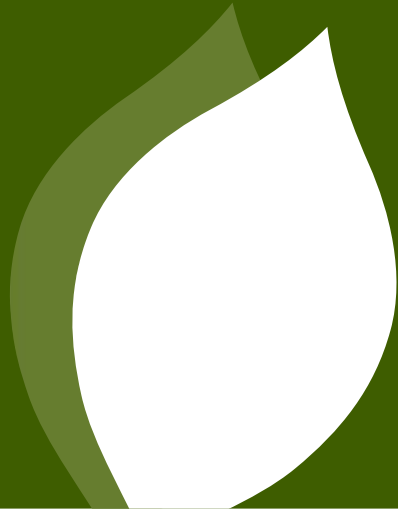
TREE PLANTING PROJECT

DUBBED:

**GREEN MY
CONTINENT**



Executive Summary



Human activities, including the burning of fossil fuels, deforestation and other changes in land use, agricultural and industrial processes, are leading to increasing atmospheric concentrations of substances that affect the radiative balance of the Earth and consequently, its temperature and other aspects of its climate. The impact of climate change has increasingly become a global phenomenon of which no country can turn a blind eye to. Governments, the private sector and civil society together to support the multilateral process and to increase and accelerate climate action and ambition. The Summit focused on key sectors where action can make the most difference, sectors such as heavy industry, nature-based solutions, cities, energy, resilience, and climate finance. World leaders reported on what they are doing, and what more they intend to do when they convene in 2020 for the UN climate conference. Over the year's world leaders have seen the need to tackle climate change hands on, the United Nations has come up with several legal instrument such as the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, Kyoto Protocol, Paris Agreement among others but the adverse effect of climate change is still being felt around the world. This is a clear indicator that more needs to be done. Climate change is expected to have unprecedented implications on where people settle, grow food, build cities, and rely on functioning ecosystems for the services they provide. In many places, temperature changes and sea-level rise are already putting ecosystems under stress and affecting human well-being.

On 23 September 2019, Secretary-General António Guterres convened a Climate Summit to bring world leaders.

Africa is the most negatively impacted continent, mainly due to its high levels of vulnerability, low adaptive capacities and widespread poverty. According to the United Nations Environment Program, between 75 and 250 million people in Africa are projected to be exposed to increased water stress due to climate change by 2020. In the same year, in some countries, yields from rain-fed agriculture could be reduced by up to 50 percent. Global warming of 2°C would put over 50 percent of the continent's population at risk of undernourishment. Projections estimate that climate change will lead to an equivalent of 2 percent to 4 percent annual loss in GDP in the region by 2040. These figures highlight the gravity of the climate variability problems facing Africa.

Without a doubt nature-based solutions are one of the practical ways to mitigate the impact of climate change on the African continent. The good news is that with the right interventions, we can turn the vicious cycle of climate change into a virtuous cycle of productive land and reductions in greenhouse gas emissions, according to scientists. By strengthening biodiversity and ecosystem services through sustainable land management, we can help people adapt to the adverse effects of climate change.

Executive Summary

Tree planting has enormous benefits to the environment, both reducing and removing carbon are key to reversing climate change. Trees help cool the planet by sucking in and storing harmful greenhouse gases, like carbon dioxide, into their trunks, branches, and leaves, and releasing oxygen back into the atmosphere. In cities, trees can reduce overall temperature by up to eight degrees Celsius. With more than 50% of the world's population living in cities, a number expected to increase to 66% by the year 2050 pollution and overheating are becoming a real threat. Fortunately, a mature tree can absorb an average of 48 lbs. of carbon dioxide per year, making cities a healthier, safer place to live. Trees play a key role in capturing rainwater and reducing the risk of natural disasters like floods and landslides. Their intricate root systems act like filters removing pollutants and slowing down the water's absorption into the ground. This process prevents harmful waterside erosion and reduces the risk of over-saturation and flooding. single tree can be home to hundreds of species of insect, fungi, moss, mammals, and plants. Depending on the kind of food and shelter they need, different forest animals require different types of habitat. Without trees, forest creatures would have nowhere to call home.

The All -Africa Students Union, AASU believes that the African students and youth play a critical role in the fight to mitigate the adverse impacts of climate change on our continent. We believe that it is imperative that we all get involved and contribute in our own small way, hence the tree planting project dubbed "GREEN MY CONTINENT".

BRIEF PROJECT DESCRIPTION

The project seeks to plant 1million trees in total across the African continent. The “GREEN MY CONTINENT” project will take on two dimensions. One will be the social media awareness creation on the impacts of deforestation and the benefits of tree planting. The campaign is intended to also inspire students and the youth across the continent to plant a tree each and take pictures with their freshly planted trees with the HASTAGS #greenmy-continent #aasutreeplanting #sdg13.

The All-Africa Students Union will dedicate the last Friday of every month as Green my Continent Day. On this day there is going to be a tree planting exercise, we intend to partner with the various student’s unions, Student leaders and relevant stakeholders in the country to make this a reality. The project will cover all 16 regions in Ghana with each region we are targeting 1,000 trees and subsequently move to other African countries in the future.

GENERAL OBJECTIVE

- The project is expected to plant 16,000 trees at the end of 2021 in Ghana.

SPECIAL OBJECTIVES

- To create awareness on the negative impact climate change has on the socio-economic development of the African continent as a whole.
- To sensitize the general public on how human activities adversely affect the environment and instil a sense of responsibility in individuals towards the environment.
- To influence and inspire governments to put to action existing policies.
- To reduce the rate of global warming.

BENEFITS OF THE PROJECT

- Planting 16,000 trees will absorb close to 4,000 tons of carbon dioxide every year in the atmosphere by the time the trees mature, this will go a long way to reduce global warming.
- There will be a general attitudinal change in individuals on the continent as they become more aware of the repercussions of their action.
- The project is going to help push for the achievement of SDG goal 13 by 2030.

EXPECTED PROJECT OUTCOMES

- Increased awareness on climate change.
- Young people planting 16,000 trees in Ghana.
- Increased high level discussions to influence policy.
- Paradigm shift in the attitudes of the youth towards climate action.

